

KEY WORKS: Toccate e partite... libro primo (First Book of Toccatas and Partitas), 1615; Ego sum panis vivus (I Am the Living Bread [vocal]), 1621; Fiori musicali (Musical Flowers [a collection of sacred organ music]), 1635

Heinrich Schütz

1585–1672, GERMAN

More than anyone else, Schütz put German music on the map, giving it an importance that it had never previously enjoyed and establishing high intellectual and technical standards that became characteristic of the country's composers. He spent most of his long career at the court in Dresden, but he also worked elsewhere in Germany and he made two lengthy visits to Venice and two to Copenhagen. His large output (there are more than 500 surviving works) is highly varied. Most of his music is religious, but he also wrote, for example, the first German opera, *Dafne* (1627), although this does not survive. His early work was much influenced by the ornate style of Italian music, but it became a lot more austere, probably in part because the devastation caused by the Thirty Years War (1618–1648) discouraged extravagance in the arts.